

## Aleksei Opacic

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Contact            | Department of Sociology<br>33 Kirkland Street, Cambridge MA 02139                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <a href="mailto:aopacic@g.harvard.edu">aopacic@g.harvard.edu</a><br><a href="https://alekseiopacic.github.io">alekseiopacic.github.io</a> |
| Research interests | Human Capital, Labor Markets and Careers, Economic Sociology, Inequality, Quantitative and Computational Methods                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                           |
| Education          | <b>Harvard University</b><br>Ph.D. Sociology (expected 2027)<br>Dissertation: “College-to-Work(place) Linkages and the Returns to Education”<br>Committee: Xiang Zhou, Christina Ciocca Eller, Chris Winship, Nathan Wilmers (MIT Sloan)<br>Exams: Stratification (Distinction), Demography (Distinction), Organizations, Gender<br>A.M. Statistics (2024)<br><b>University of Oxford</b><br>M.Sc. Sociology (2019), <i>Distinction (Ranked First)</i><br><b>University of Cambridge</b><br>B.A. Social and Political Science (2018), <i>Starred First Class (Ranked First)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                           |
| Publications       | <b>Opacic, Aleksei</b> (2026). “ <a href="#">Where Do the Returns to Schooling Come From? Educational Transitions and Labor Market Payoffs.</a> ” Accepted at <i>Annals of Applied Statistics</i> . <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Clifford C. Clogg Graduate Student Paper Award, Methodology Section, American Sociological Association</li><li>• Outstanding Graduate Student Paper Award, Mathematical Sociology Section, American Sociological Association</li></ul> <b>Opacic, Aleksei</b> , Lai Wei, and Xiang Zhou (2026). “ <a href="#">Disparity Analysis: A Tale of Two Approaches.</a> ” <i>Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series A: Statistics in Society</i> , 189, 805–833.<br>Bloome, Deirdre, and <b>Aleksei Opacic</b> (2024). “ <a href="#">Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages.</a> ” <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i> , 121 (25). |                                                                                                                                           |
| Under review       | “Who Gets to Use Their College Skills? Skill-Job Alignment and Earnings Inequality Among College Graduates.” <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Geoffrey Tootell Award, Mathematical Sociology Section, American Sociological Association</li></ul> “ <a href="#">From Flagship to Firm: Employer Sorting and the Organizational Returns to College.</a> ” <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Ronald Burt Student Paper Award, Economic Sociology Section, Honorable Mention, American Sociological Association</li></ul> “ <a href="#">Marginal Interventional Effects</a> ” (with Xiang Zhou). Resubmitted to <i>Statistical Science</i> .<br>“ <a href="#">Assumption Smuggling in Tests of Causal Mechanisms</a> ” (with Matthew Blackwell and Ruofan Ma).                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                           |
| Works in progress  | “Matchmakers and Gatekeepers: AI Recommendations and Racial Disparities in Hiring.”<br>“Explaining Gradational Inequalities” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                           |

|                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Book chapters                     | Evans, Geoffrey, and <b>Aleksei Opacic</b> (2022). “ <a href="#">How Social Class Influences Political Choices</a> .” <i>The Cambridge Handbook of Political Psychology</i> , eds. Danny Osborne and Chris G. Sibley. Cambridge University Press. pp. 382–398.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Software                          | “disparity: Estimation of Descriptive and Prescriptive Disparity Estimands” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou). <a href="https://github.com/alekseiopacic/disparity">github.com/alekseiopacic/disparity</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Other writing                     | <p>“<a href="#">Education to Workforce Pathways Diagnostic Toolkit: Analysis Narrative</a>” (2024, with Atticus Bolyard, Sue Dynarski, Jon Fullerton, Miriam Greenberg, Julia Lubner, Eric Taylor, and Rachel Worsham).</p> <p>“<a href="#">Education to Workforce Pathways Diagnostic Toolkit: Technical Guide</a>” (2024, with Atticus Bolyard, Sue Dynarski, Jon Fullerton, Miriam Greenberg, Julia Lubner, Eric Taylor, and Rachel Worsham).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Courses taught                    | <p><i>Harvard University</i></p> <p>Teaching Fellow, Intermediate Quantitative Methods (2022–3). <i>Certificate of Distinction in Teaching</i></p> <p>Teaching Fellow, Advanced Quantitative Methods (2025).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Research awards and fellowships   | <p>Geoffrey Tootell Outstanding Dissertation-in-Progress Award, ASA Mathematical Sociology Section (2026, \$5,000)</p> <p>IQSS Research Grant (2025, \$2,000)</p> <p>James M. and Cathleen D. Stone Research Grant (2025, \$5,000)</p> <p>IQSS Research Grant (2024, \$3,000)</p> <p>Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant (2024, \$10,000)</p> <p>Center for American Political Studies Seed Grant, Harvard University (2024, \$1,000)</p> <p>Jeanne Humphrey Block Dissertation Award, Harvard University (2024, \$2,500)</p> <p>Population Center Dissertation Research Award, Harvard University (2024, \$2,000)</p> <p>Linda G. Hammett Ory Fellowship, Harvard Graduate School of Education (2023, \$15,000)</p> <p>Kennedy Scholarship, Harvard University (2020, \$20,000)</p> <p>The A.H. Halsey Prize, University of Oxford (2019)</p> <p>The Polity Prize, The Pollard Memorial Prize, and King’s College Scholarship, University of Cambridge (2018)</p> |
| Invited talks                     | <p>Harvard Data Science Initiative (HDSI), Harvard University (2026)</p> <p>Quantitative Social Science Colloquium, Dartmouth College (2026)</p> <p>Education Data Science Seminar, Stanford University (2025)</p> <p>Economic Sociology Seminar, Harvard University/MIT (2025)</p> <p>Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2024)</p> <p>Inequality Workshop, Stanford University (2023)</p> <p>Social Demography Seminar, Harvard University (2022)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Selected conference presentations | <p>“Who Gets to Use Their College Skills? Skill-Job Alignment and Earnings Inequality Among College Graduates.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO (April 2026).</p> <p>“From Flagship to Firm: Employer Sorting and the Organizational Returns to College.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Chicago, IL (August 2025).</p> <p>“Assumption Smuggling in Tests of Causal Mechanisms” (with Matthew Blackwell and Ruofan Ma). Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Philadelphia, PA (August 2024).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|              | <p>“Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages” (with Deirdre Bloome). Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montreal, CA (August 2024).</p> <p>“Cumulative Disadvantage and the BA Attainment Gap.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montreal, CA (August 2024).</p> <p>“Absolute Income Mobility Obscures Marginalized Children’s Disadvantages” (with Deirdre Bloome). Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Columbus, OH (April 2024).</p> <p>“Path-Specific Effects under Monotonic Mediation.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Columbus (April 2024).</p> <p>“Path-Specific Effects under Monotonic Mediation.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Philadelphia, PA (August 2023).</p> <p>“Disparity Analysis: A Tale of Two Approaches” (with Lai Wei and Xiang Zhou). Annual Meeting of the International Sociological Association, Melbourne, Australia (June 2023, Declined).</p> <p>“Does Higher Education Tend Towards Egalitarianism? Evidence from a Population Transitions Model.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, New Orleans, LA (April 2023).</p> <p>“An Interventional Approach to Primary and Secondary Effects in Intergenerational Mobility.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Los Angeles, CA (August 2022).</p> <p>“Marginal Interventional Effects” (with Xiang Zhou). Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, Los Angeles, CA (August 2022).</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Experience   | <p><b>Netflix</b> — Experimentation &amp; Causal Inference Researcher (2025), Los Gatos, CA</p> <p><b>Institute for Global Change</b> — Researcher (2019–2020), London, UK</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Service      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Sociology Tenure-Track Faculty Search Committee, Harvard University (2024–2025)</li> <li>• Sociology Graduate Admissions Committee, Harvard University (2021–2022)</li> <li>• <i>Invited Reviewer</i>: American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, Social Forces, Sociology of Education, Political Behavior, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Sociological Methods and Research</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Affiliations | <p>American Sociological Association; Academy of Management; Population Association of America; American Statistical Association; Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard; Center for Population and Development Studies, Harvard School of Public Health; EdRedesign, Harvard Graduate School of Education</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| References   | <p><b>Xiang Zhou</b><br/> Professor of Sociology<br/> Harvard University<br/> <a href="mailto:xiang_zhou@fas.harvard.edu">xiang_zhou@fas.harvard.edu</a></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p><b>Christina Ciocca Eller</b><br/> Assistant Professor of Sociology<br/> Harvard University<br/> <a href="mailto:cceller@fas.harvard.edu">cceller@fas.harvard.edu</a></p> <p><b>Christopher Winship</b><br/> Diker-Tishman Research Professor of Sociology<br/> Harvard University<br/> <a href="mailto:cwinship@wjh.harvard.edu">cwinship@wjh.harvard.edu</a></p> |
|              | <p><b>Nathan Wilmers</b><br/> Erwin H. Schell Associate Professor of Management<br/> MIT Sloan School of Management<br/> <a href="mailto:wilmers@mit.edu">wilmers@mit.edu</a></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |